

BO.IT MAKING WAVES

A new page sharing service called <http://bo.it> lets you create an editable copy of any webpage on its

servers. You can then change the text, edit and delete images and text and change links and share the page on Twitter or Facebook. Check it out:

<http://tcrn.ch/digit055>

WHERE ARE THE WOMEN IN WIKIPEDIA?

As it turns out less than 15 percent of Wikipedia's contributors are women. Read this discussion that tries to find out if something about Wikipedia's format and purpose attracts more male contributors unlike sites like Flickr and Yelp that do not appear to have this gender gap. Are there ways to alter this gap?

<http://nyti.ms/digit060>

YOUTUBE INSTANT CREATOR DOES IT AGAIN

After the phenomenal attention he got for YouTube instant, Feross Aboukhadijeh has come up with a new mash up called Instant.fm. It lets you drag a playlist from various sources and the service queues up YouTube videos of the songs in the list, playing them in the playlist's order. <http://bit.ly/id4gFV>

tablet-friendly apps that work well is very low. We could linger on this section, but the bottom line is simple: if you want lots of apps for your tablet, right now, nothing out there beats the iPad. It sounds simple, but the variation in size (and manufacturers) complicates things greatly. It remains to be seen what kind of options will exist for the BlackBerry PlayBook. Eventually, one hopes, the other app stores will catch up to Apple, but if a wide range of compelling apps is your main priority, Apple is currently your best bet.

DESIGN AND SIZE

First things first: When you hear the term "10-inch tablet," this typically refers to the size of the screen, measured diagonally, and not the size of the tablet itself. Apple continues to offer the iPad in one size only (9.7-inch screen). The Xoom comes in one screen size too (10.1 inches), but Samsung just announced new Galaxy Tab models in multiple sizes (8.9- and 10.1-inches) in addition to the current 7-inch Tab. In other words, you have plenty of options, but the higher quality tablets thus far have veered towards the larger end of the scale since they offer a better finger-centric, touch screen experience. At around 1.5 pounds (in the case of the iPad 2) they're not as light, as say, your cell phone. After you hold one on the subway for ten minutes, your hand will get tired. Setting it flat in your lap, rather propped up on a stand, is also a little awkward. As for storage, the more the better—those apps, when combined with a typical music, video, and photo library, can take up a lot of space. Right now storage tops out at 64GB of flash-based memory, with many

of the quality tablets we've seen available in 16, 32, and 64GB varieties. Larger capacity models can get as expensive as full-featured laptops, especially when you factor in cellular service plans.

WI-FI-ONLY VS. CELLULAR MODELS

Most tablets come in a Wi-Fi-only model or with the option to pay by the month for 3G (or eventually, 4G) always-on cellular service from a provider like AT&T, Sprint, T-Mobile, or Verizon Wireless. If you want to use your tablet to get online anywhere, you should opt for a model with a cell radio. Another way to get your tablet online: Use your 3G or 4G phone as a Wi-Fi hotspot for your tablet—this won't work with every phone/tablet combo, so you should check with the carriers before you buy in.

CAMERAS & VIDEO CHATTING

With the release of the iPad 2, Apple caught up rather quickly to its tablet competition and added front- and rear-facing cameras for stills and video. The Xoom has a higher quality rear-facing



camera than the iPad's lackluster offering. The inclusion of front-facing cameras means tablets offer video chat features—but not all video chat apps are created equal. Google Talk for Honeycomb, which comes preloaded on the Xoom, is a top-notch app; simple to use, and it operates via Google accounts. You can chat with

anyone who has a Google account. However, not all Android tablets are created equal—be wary of any tablets that lack access to the Android Market. It's also worth pointing out that any Android tablet lacking Honeycomb, like the Dell Streak 7, is not running an OS intended for a tablet, and thus, its apps often offer a weak user experience. The Streak 7 utilizes inferior apps for chatting and cannot utilize the Honeycomb version of Google Talk. Apple's FaceTime works similarly well, but is limited to certain Apple products, making it far less versatile than Google Talk.

PRICE

Like with most gadgetry, you get what you pay for, and tablets are no exception. If you spend anything less than \$500-\$600 (which seems to be the magic entry-range for Wi-Fi-only models like the iPad 2 and the Motorola Xoom), don't say we didn't warn you. The CherryPal Cherry Pad is a fine example of what \$188 will get you in the tablet world—not a lot, including a low-quality screen and a serious lack of features. As for 3G (and 4G) enabled tablets, the pricing varies widely depending on manufacturer, capacity, and plan, but expect to pay at least about \$20 per month on top of a higher up front fee—the lowest iPad 2 3G tablet price is \$629 for 16GB, for instance. Finally, before you buy, if you can, head to your local electronics store to get hands-on time with some different tablets, so you can see which feels and works the best for you. And for the latest lab-tested tablet reviews, hit our Tablet Product Guide. For more: <http://bit.ly/pcmagl>